

New IDE MSc Graduation Rubric

Key information for supervisors

The new IDE MSc programmes, introduced in September 2024, brought new learning objectives (LOs) and Final Attainment Levels (FALs). The graduation rubric has now been revised to align with these new LOs and FALs, while also incorporating insights from previous graduation assessments. The new rubric provides a clearer and more consistent framework for assessing graduation projects, while allowing for the diversity of projects across the MSc programmes.

The new rubric will apply to graduation projects that start on or after **23 September 2026**.

This means that for the coming period two Graduation Project rubrics are in place: the current one and the new one. In MyCase you can find which rubric applies to the graduation project you supervise. For this, you can check the course code that is assigned to the case. You can find the course code in the summary of the student's case:

- For cases with the course codes ID4190-16, ID4290-16, ID4390-16, IDEM1000, IDEM2000 and IDEM3000, the "old" rubric should be used. This rubric will appear in MyCase in the finalisation phase.
- For cases with the course codes IDEM1001, IDEM2001 and IDEM3001, the new rubric should be used. In MyCase you will receive a link to the interactive tool in which the rubric is build. After filling in this rubric, a pdf must be uploaded to MyCase to complete the assessment and finalise the case.

Structure of the redesigned rubric

The rubric assesses the 8 learning objectives (LOs) of the MSc graduation project through 19 criterion descriptors. The descriptors provide the evidence for assessment, while each LO is assessed holistically against four clearly distinguished performance levels. The four levels correspond to 2, 4, 7, and 11 points. The eight LOs are equally weighted, and their scores are combined through a transparent points-to-grade conversion to arrive at a recommended final grade.

For each LO, the selected performance level and corresponding points should be substantiated in the comments field, providing a clear basis for the assessment.

The rubric supports independent assessment by the two supervisors. Both supervisors complete the rubric independently. Their assessments then form the basis for discussion, after which a final assessment must be completed while the supervisory team is expected to provide written feedback.

The rubric also allows students from different programmes to demonstrate the LOs in ways appropriate to their project and context. The calculated grade is a recommendation; the supervisory team retains the final responsibility for determining the grade. The final grade may

therefore differ from the recommended final grade, provided that the deviation is substantiated in the assessment form.

	Learning objective	Theme	No. of Criteria
LO 1	Envision and refine the design or research challenge.	Framing	3
LO 2	Identify, acquire, critique, and integrate knowledge from domains relevant to the challenge.	Knowledge	3
LO 3	Explain and justify the choice and application of methods.	Methods	1
LO 4	Iteratively develop, prototype, and test concepts.	Iteration	3
LO 5	Address the identified challenge to shape possible, sustainable, and just futures.	Process & Outcome	3
LO 6	Navigate complexities associated with the project.	Navigation	3
LO 7	Communicate across written, verbal, and visual modes appropriate to the context.	Communication	2
LO 8	Reflect on process and outcome from academic and practitioner perspectives.	Reflection	1

What has changed from the 2018 rubric?

The following table outlines the main changes:

	2018 rubric (ID4x95)	New rubric
Content emphasis	Project result framed as feasibility, desirability, viability	Process and outcome framed as possible, sustainable, just, in accordance with language used in the new MSc programme.
Scored units	Five competencies, 12 sub-criteria, plus a separate Time spent row; each row scored on a grade scale	Eight learning objectives, 19 criterion descriptors; one point score per learning outcome. The points will not be visible against the LOs (see “scale” in the row below).
Scale	Seven grade columns (4–10), but only 5 distinct descriptor bands; the 7–8 and 9–10 columns share a single descriptor.	Four performance levels, clearly distinguished, worth 2 / 4 / 7 / 11 points. The points are not shown on the form itself at the individual LO levels to minimise bias (See Section 2) and encourage supervisors to examine the qualitative descriptors. For transparency, the conversion is

	2018 rubric (ID4x95)	New rubric
		made available to students and supervisors and shown on a downloadable PDF.
Aggregation	Stated on the document itself: the final grade is not necessarily the mean of the parts. The rule was never specified.	A published, piecewise-linear formula, a conversion table, and a chart (Appendix 2).
Weighting	Implicit and undeclared	Equal weighting proposed across all eight learning objectives, declared in advance.
Grade anchoring	Grades visible in the column headers while judging	Descriptors first; the grade is derived afterwards.
Delay / time	Separate Time spent row with a hard cap (max 8.0 if Green Light was not initially granted)	Delay is embedded in the LO 6 Planning descriptors; no cap mechanism.

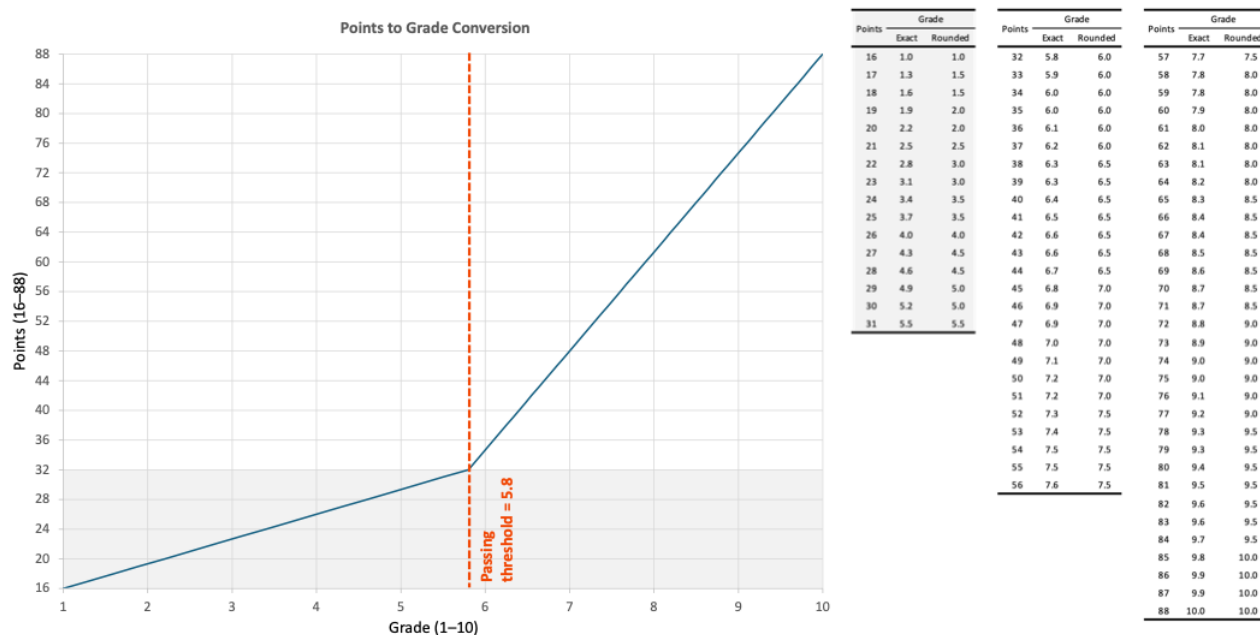
Coverage of the Final Attainment Levels

FAL	A Master's graduate Industrial Design Engineering is able to...	Assessed via
1	...explore, select and adopt design practices by critically integrating them in their own process and adapting them to diverse contexts	LO 3
2	...build a strong design rationale based on design reasoning, informed by academic and/or self-conducted design research, in reference to possible, sustainable and just futures	LO 1, LO 5
3	...integrate knowledge relevant to the design challenge into design concepts	LO 2, LO 4
4	...explore the unknown and show creativity in framing, conceptualising and prototyping design outcomes	LO 1, LO 4
5	...understand, independently plan and conduct academic research to generate new knowledge for, about, or through design	LO 3, LO 6
6	...autonomously acquire and judge relevant contemporary disciplinary knowledge, as common practice for life-long learning	LO 2, LO 8
7	...position themselves in a professional context and demonstrate confidence, reflexivity, and agency in acting within it	LO 6, LO 8
8	...analyse, discuss, and anticipate the role of design at individual, organisational, societal and planetary levels and their interactions	LO 5
9	...work collaboratively, ethically, and inclusively within and across disciplines and stakeholders	LO 5, LO 6

FAL	A Master's graduate Industrial Design Engineering is able to...	Assessed via
10	...communicate professionally in writing, visually and verbally about research outcomes and design solutions	LO 7
11	...develop and evaluate design outcomes, directions or proposals to a level of detail permitting implementation	LO 4, LO 5

Score-to-grade conversion

The following chart shows the points-to-grade conversion:



The points are converted to a final grade using a transparent formula, with 32 points as the effective pass threshold (equivalent to 4 points for each LO, resulting in a rounded grade of 6.0). Scores range from 16 points (grade 1) to 88 points (grade 10), with finer grade differentiation applied across the passing range. The shallow first segment of the chart moves quickly through the failing range; the steep second segment gives fine discrimination across the passing range, where distinctions matter.

The effective cutoff score for a “pass” is 32 points, which yields an exact grade of 5.8 and a rounded grade of 6.0. 31 points yields 5.5 and does not pass.

Moving forward

The new IDE MSc graduation rubric establishes a more transparent and consistent approach to assessing graduation projects, while better accommodating the diversity of graduation projects and the different ways in which students can demonstrate their learning. Its successful implementation will depend not only on a shared understanding among assessors, but also on a cultural shift

towards assessing performance levels rather than working backwards from a grade. The redesigned rubric therefore represents a meaningful shift in how graduation projects are assessed.

Looking ahead, a broader reform of the graduation structure is also being developed, as the current model is no longer considered sustainable. The new rubric should be seen as an important step within this wider development. For detailed information on the development and structure of the rubric please take a look at the MSc Graduation part of the [IDE Teachers' Manual](#).